

If you're an Android user eager to update to Kodi 21.0, you have a couple of options to get the update sooner. You can sideload the update, or you can join the Google Play Kodi testing track, which will expedite the release process.



Kodi 21.0 brings several enhancements for different platforms and features. For Xbox, it adds HDR10 support, while Windows users benefit from DXVA2 AV1 hardware video decoding for both 8-bit and 10-bit content.

Additionally, there's support for 'video super resolution' on NVIDIA RTX and Intel ARC compatible hardware. Windows 11 users will also appreciate the refresh rate switching, along with colour accuracy changes for 10-bit SDR/HDR colour mapping.

Other improvements include better handling of movement keys in certain lists like Settings, fixed thumbnail generation for pictures in portrait orientation, support for video information for Movie Sets and TV Seasons, and numerous enhancements to the default Estuary theme.

Sup3rCC will evaluate how climate change is impacting renewable energy demand and supply

As the global shift towards renewable energy sources like wind and solar intensifies, so does the need for advanced data to manage the interplay between weather conditions and energy systems. According to researchers at the US Department of Energy's National Renewable Energy Laboratory (NREL), extreme weather events—now more frequent due to climate change—are impacting energy demands and resource availability.

NREL scientists, including Grant Buster, Brandon Benton, Andrew Glaws, and Ryan King, have developed an innovative solution named Super-Resolution for Renewable Energy Resource Data with Climate Change Impacts (Sup3rCC). Detailed in a recent *Nature Energy* journal article, this tool utilises generative machine learning to produce high-resolution climate data, enhancing the understanding of how climate change could affect renewable energy sources and energy demand.



Sup3rCC addresses a critical gap in current energy and climate research, which often operates in isolated silos. Traditional global climate models, although extensive, do not offer the detailed resolution necessary for precise energy system modelling and are costly to enhance. These models frequently omit specific outputs vital for assessing renewable energy generation.

This new model represents a significant advance in the field by producing physically realistic, high-resolution data about 40 times faster than traditional methods. By leveraging generative adversarial networks (GANs), the tool efficiently enhances the spatial and temporal resolution of climate data, which is essential for modelling the future of renewable energy generation and demand.

OIN, Microsoft, and The Linux Foundation continue collaboration against patent trolls

The Open Invention Network (OIN), The Linux Foundation, and Microsoft will continue their collaboration in the Unified Patents' Open Source Zone (OS Zone) for the fifth consecutive year, to protect open source software (OSS) from Patent Assertion Entities (PAEs), commonly known as patent trolls.

The funding for the OS Zone is supported by business giants like Amazon, Apple, CableLabs, Mercedes-Benz, Meta, ServiceNow, and Twilio.

The collaboration limits the ability of PAEs to exploit low-quality patents and engage in costly litigation against OSS projects. It emphasises the importance of protecting open source innovation to drive technological advancements and community collaboration.

"We are also pleased to welcome new companies that are providing financial support to continue funding the OS Zone's operations. More needs to be done, however, because the stakes are becoming higher as better funded PAEs are placing acute focus on critical OSS projects," said Keith Bergelt, CEO of Open Invention Network.

Jim Zemlin, executive director at The Linux Foundation, emphasised the importance of protecting OSS from patent abuse. "The speed of innovation and quality of software development is driven by collaborators working towards a common goal, organised through a project ecosystem that produces artefacts made freely available to everyone," he said. "We are pleased to continue to support the OS Zone and the removal of poor quality patents exploited against users of OSS projects and technologies."

Microsoft's associate general counsel for open source, Justin Colannino, called on other companies to support solutions that safeguard open source innovation. "Companies building products using open source technologies must help protect open source communities from threats posed by abusers of low quality patents," he said.

OIN, supported by major companies like Google, IBM, NEC, Philips, Sony, SUSE, and Toyota, offers patent non-aggression agreements and cross-licences on a royalty-free basis to its community members.